

SOP #7 – Troubleshooting Techniques for Air Handlers (AHUs) & Rooftop Units (RTUs)

Applies to: Single-zone, multi-zone, VAV, constant volume, packaged RTUs, DX & chilled water units

1. Common Failure Signs & Diagnoses

Symptom	Likely Cause	Recommended Action
Low or no airflow	Dirty filters, failed fan/motor	Replace filters, check belts, test motor
Unit short cycles	Faulty thermostat or pressure switch	Calibrate or replace control component
High return air temp	Cooling coil fouled, economizer stuck	Clean coil, check damper positions
Excess humidity	Improper reheat, oversized unit	Adjust setpoints or dehumidification coil
Water leakage inside or roof	Blocked drain pan or disconnected trap	Clean pan, check and reconnect condensate